Conversation track 22, 24, 25

In a team meeting, Edward and Eleanor discuss a new policy on working from home.

Edward: So, management wants us in the office three days a week. Thoughts?

Eleanor: **If you ask me**, it's a step backward. We're more productive at home.

Edward: **I see what you mean, but** we've barely seen each other for months.

Eleanor: **That's a fair point.** Our video calls can feel a bit flat.

Edward: **The way I see it**, some time together would do us good.

Eleanor: **I'm not so sure about** three, though. Some of us live over an hour away.

Edward: Fair enough. Shall we propose two, then, and let people choose?

Eleanor: **I couldn't agree more.** Let's run it by management.

Study Notes

Thoughts?
Mọi người thấy sao?
Cách hỏi ý kiến ngắn gọn, thân mật trong cuộc họp, ngay sau khi nêu một vấn đề.
Cách nói tương đương: What does everyone think?

Let's run it by management.
Mình trình ý này lên ban quản lý xem sao.
"run something by someone" là hỏi ý kiến hoặc xin ai đó duyệt trước khi quyết định.
Cách nói tương đương: Let's check with management.

Speak Like a Native track 23

1. If you ask me, it's a step backward.
weak: "you", "a"
linking: "it's‿a"
strong: "ask", "backward"
Đọc liền "If you ask me" rồi ngừng ngắn. Giọng Mỹ đọc "ask" /æsk/ "ésk", giọng Anh đọc /ɑːsk/ "aask". "it's a" nối thành "it-sơ".

2. I see what you mean, but we've barely seen each other for months.
change: "what‿you" (t + y → "ch")
weak: "but"
strong: "mean", "months"
Giọng xuống rồi hơi lên ở "mean" (lịch sự, báo hiệu sắp nói ý khác), ngừng ngắn trước "but". "what you" đọc thành "wo-chu".

3. I'm not so sure about three, though.
linking: "sure‿about"
strong: "three"
Nhấn "three" (chỉ phản đối con số, không phản đối cả ý). "though" xuống rồi hơi lên cho lời phản đối mềm hơn. "sure about" nối âm /r/: "shua-rơ-bao".

• Phản đối lịch sự: giọng xuống rồi hơi lên ở cuối cụm (I see what you mean… / …though), không xuống hẳn.
• Nhấn vào đúng từ mình muốn bàn lại: not so sure about THREE.
• Cụm mở đầu (If you ask me, The way I see it) đọc liền một hơi rồi ngừng ngắn.
• Giọng Anh và giọng Mỹ khác nhau ở "ask", "can't": /ɑː/ (Anh) và /æ/ (Mỹ).

Grammar Focus

Nêu ý kiến: If you ask me / The way I see it / In my view

Đặt ở đầu câu để báo đây là ý kiến riêng, nghe mềm hơn nói thẳng. "If you ask me" thân mật; "In my view" trang trọng hơn.

If you ask me, the movie was too long.
The way I see it, we need more staff.
In my view, the price is a little high.

Đồng ý và phản đối lịch sự

Đồng ý hoàn toàn: I couldn't agree more. Đồng ý một phần: That's a fair point. Phản đối nhẹ nhàng: I see what you mean, but… / I'm not so sure about…

We need a break. – **I couldn't agree more**.
I see what you mean, but it's too risky.
I'm not so sure about the new logo.

Role Play track 27

A: So, management wants us in the office three days a week. Thoughts?

B: _____, it's a step backward. We're more productive at home.

A: I see what you mean, but we've barely seen each other for months.

B: _____. Our video calls can feel a bit flat.

A: The way I see it, some time together would do us good.

B: _____ three, though. Some of us live over an hour away.

A: Fair enough. Shall we propose two, then, and let people choose?

B: I couldn't agree more. Let's run it by management.

Substitution Drill track 28

1. If you ask me, it's a step backward.
   a. Personally
   b. In my opinion
   c. To be honest

2. That's a fair point. Our video calls can feel a bit flat.
   a. Good point
   b. That's true
   c. You've got a point there

3. I'm not so sure about three, though.
   a. I'm a bit worried about
   b. I have my doubts about
   c. I'm not sold on